

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Problem-Solving and Data Analysis	Probability and conditional probability	Easy

Question

The table gives the distribution of votes for a new school mascot and grade level for 80 students.

Mascot	Grade level			
	Sixth	Seventh	Eighth	Total
Badger	4	9	9	22
Lion	9	2	9	20
Longhorn	4	6	4	14
Tiger	6	9	9	24
Total	23	26	31	80

If one of these students is selected at random, what is the probability of selecting a student whose vote for new mascot was for a lion?

Answer

- A. $\frac{1}{9}$
- B. $\frac{1}{5}$
- C. $\frac{1}{4}$
- D. $\frac{2}{3}$

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. If one of these students is selected at random, the probability of selecting a student whose vote for the new mascot was for a lion is given by the number of votes for a lion divided by the total number of votes. The given table indicates that the number of votes for a lion is **20** votes, and the total number of votes is **80** votes. The table gives the distribution of votes for **80** students, and the table shows a total of 80 votes were counted. It follows that each of the **80** students voted exactly once. Thus, the probability of selecting a student whose vote for the new mascot was for a lion is $\frac{20}{80}$, or $\frac{1}{4}$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or computational errors.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or computational errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or computational errors.